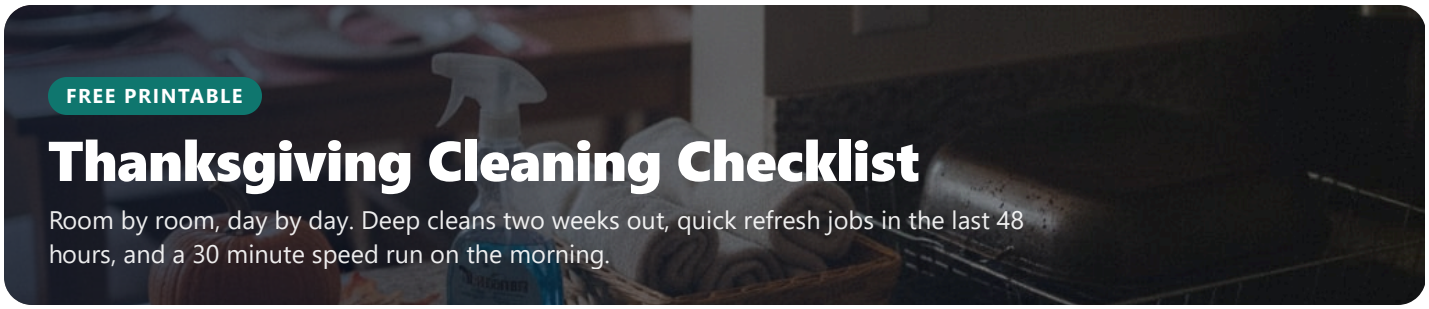


FREE PRINTABLE

Thanksgiving Cleaning Checklist

Room by room, day by day. Deep cleans two weeks out, quick refresh jobs in the last 48 hours, and a 30 minute speed run on the morning.

Print it, stick it on the fridge, and tick the boxes as you go. Each phase is written so the work is done before the kitchen needs you. The full guide with the why behind every job is on the site.

TWO WEEKS OUT

The deep cleans that stay done

- [ ] Deep clean the oven, including the door glass and the racks
- [ ] Run a cleaning cycle on the dishwasher
- [ ] Descale the coffee maker, then two cycles of plain water
- [ ] Clean and deodorize the garbage disposal (ice, salt, citrus peel)
- [ ] Declutter the entryway, the living room surfaces, and the coat spot
- [ ] Ceiling fan blades in the dining and living rooms
- [ ] Baseboards in the hallway, bathroom, and dining room
- [ ] Window and door tracks by the entry
- [ ] Light switches and door handles along the guest path

ONE WEEK OUT

Bathrooms, floors, and fabric

- [ ] Guest bathroom top to bottom: toilet (ring, base, floor behind), sink, mirror
- [ ] Counter cleared to soap and one hand towel; backup toilet paper where guests can find it
- [ ] Shower curtain or liner washed if the shower is visible
- [ ] Floors vacuumed everywhere guests walk, then mopped
- [ ] Couch cushions off, frame vacuumed, stains spot cleaned
- [ ] Throw blankets, pillow covers, and the bathroom rug washed

THREE DAYS OUT

The kitchen gets its turn

- [ ] Fridge cleared and wiped, shelves and drawers washed, one shelf left empty
- [ ] Microwave wiped inside and out
- [ ] Stainless steel fronts wiped with the grain, then dried
- [ ] Kitchen sponge replaced or sterilized
- [ ] Every trash bin emptied, rinsed, and dried outside
- [ ] Fruit fly check around the fruit bowl and the drains

THE DAY BEFORE

Refresh, do not clean

- [ ] Quick vacuum or sweep of the guest path floors only
- [ ] Bathroom counter, faucet, and mirror wiped; toilet paper restocked
- [ ] Couch cushions fluffed, throws folded
- [ ] Every trash can in the house emptied
- [ ] Sink and dishwasher completely empty
- [ ] Serving dishes and utensils set out
- [ ] Simmer pot on the stove: orange peel, cinnamon stick, a few cloves

THANKSGIVING MORNING

The 30 minute speed run

- [ ] Bathroom, 8 minutes: counter, toilet seat, toilet paper, guest hand towel
- [ ] Entryway, 5 minutes: shoes away, coat spot clear, doormat shaken
- [ ] Living room, 7 minutes: cushions, surfaces, one pass with the vacuum
- [ ] Kitchen, 10 minutes: counters clear, sink empty, trash out, fresh oven towel
- [ ] Then stop. Go deal with the turkey.

AFTER THE FEAST

The damage control hour

- [ ] Scrape and load the dishes right away; roasting pan washed while warm
- [ ] Tablecloth and carpet stains treated now: blot, never rub
- [ ] Leftovers in the fridge within two hours
- [ ] Turkey fat into a can to set, never down the drain
- [ ] Counters wiped, trash out
- [ ] Everything else waits until morning

What guests notice most

The bathroom
They are alone in it, at close range. The toilet base and hinges count more than the mirror.

How the house smells at the door
A simmer pot beats any candle, and it covers a day of cooking.

Clear surfaces
Clutter makes a clean room look dirty. Clear the counters and the coffee table first.

Nothing behind a closed door
Bedrooms, the office, and the garage do not need to be on this list. Close them.

Notes and who is bringing what